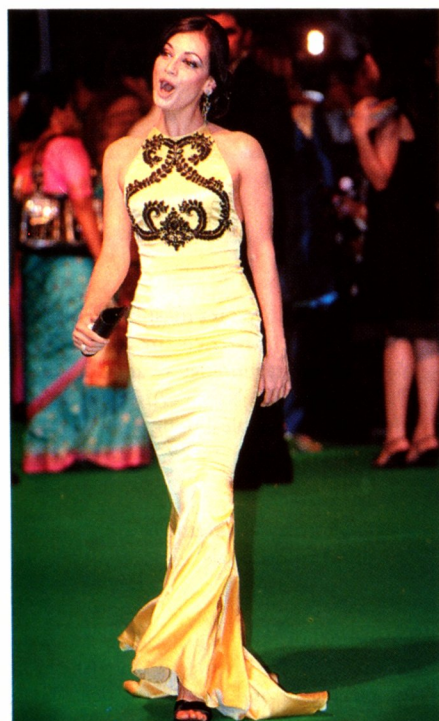




DRESSING DOWN

The green carpet at IIFA in Bangkok was stained with fashion faux pas as **Dia Mirza** (above) stepped out in a Shantanu and Nikhil lemon-yellow gown that would have fared better without the black web, **Ayesha Takia** was disastrous as ever in a fringed number and **Shriya Saran** looked like she had borrowed her back-up dancer's blingy drape. But the oh-no award goes to Fardeen Khan's wife **Natasha** (left), who sported a garden for a bodice. Surely it can't be so hard to hire a stylist.



P.RAMAMOHN REDDY

ON THE DIVINE TRAIL

Remember Abhishek Bachchan and Aishwarya Rai's pre-nuptial temple tour? **Shilpa Shetty** seems to be taking the same divine route. The actor sought the blessings of Lord Venkateswara of Tirupati with NRI arm candy Raj Kundra in tow. "I woke up very early for the 3 a.m. *darshan*. Lord Balaji has been very kind to me, so the climb didn't bother me," she told waiting media persons. Do we hear wedding bells?



BHASKAR PAUL

Triple Treat

After *Chandni Bar* and *Page 3*, **Madhur Bhandarkar** has done it again. He has won the National Award for *Traffic Signal*, a slice-of-life film on the business of begging. "This only adds to what people will expect from my next film, *Fashion*," he says. Perhaps he'll be fourth-time lucky.

The Big Bang

The long-legged, curly-haired **Kamal Siddhu** has long been missing from big-screen action. Last seen hosting the Animal Planet reality show *Chasing Nature*, she's now back to chasing her 70-mm dreams. Pushing 40, Siddhu enters brazen territory, playing a prostitute in Amol Shetge's English language film, *The Saint Who Thought Otherwise*, which has Mahesh Manjrekar in the lead role. "I saw her in *Aar Ya Paar*. Hindi is not her first language, so she wasn't comfortable speaking it. But she's fantastic in this one," says Shetge. We sure hope for a saintly Bollywood stint.



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